



Slop / University

Every Voucher Counts

Support that shows up where people
already are



Why Slop University

Support rarely announces itself. It shows up as a token at a café till, a scan at the gym door, a voucher slipped across a bookshop counter — ordinary transactions that, taken together, are how a university actually looks after the people who keep it running. Slop University has built its wellbeing program around exactly this insight: care that meets people at the counters they already visit, rather than a benefit they have to go looking for.

What makes the program distinctive is not the counters themselves but what stands behind them. The Adaptive Metrics Lab and the Trajectory Analytics Group have spent years building the instruments that let the University know, with unusual precision, whether a support scheme is actually reaching who it's meant to reach — and whether the reaching itself is worth counting. Partners who support this work aren't funding a slogan. They're funding the quiet, unglamorous architecture that makes a promise like "we've got you covered" something the University can stand behind, claim by claim.

This brochure introduces that architecture, the research that keeps it honest, and the people building both. We hope you'll read it as an invitation.



By the numbers

A quick look at how support, and the systems that track it, sit together across the University.



A campus that shows up

Staff and students draw on wellbeing support at the counters they already use — the café, the gym, the bookshop — rather than a scheme they have to seek out separately.



Research that checks its own tools

The Adaptive Metrics Lab builds the systems that track support programs, then turns the same scrutiny on the systems themselves.



Support you don't have to chase

A voucher scheme designed around where people already are, redeemed without a separate application or a second queue.



Every claim, on the record

From issue to redemption, the University keeps a single record of what support was offered and what was actually used.

Where ideas count

Adaptive Metrics Lab

The School of Continuous Improvement's flagship lab was built on a simple premise: a measurement system that isn't checked against the thing it measures is just a story the institution tells itself. The Adaptive Metrics Lab designs, calibrates, and audits the instruments behind Slop University's support programs — including the wellbeing voucher scheme this brochure describes — and has increasingly turned that same

discipline on tools built to serve staff directly, like the Living Dashboard and the check-in systems that feed it.

Partner support extends the Lab's capacity to do this work at the pace the University now needs it: new counters, new schemes, and new promises all arrive faster than any one team can independently verify. A gift to the Lab funds the unglamorous middle step between a benefit being announced and a benefit being trustworthy — the audit, the recount, the honest look at what a dashboard actually says once someone checks.



Trajectory Analytics Group

Foresight sounds abstract until it's applied to something as concrete as a car park. The Trajectory Analytics Group, the School of Emergent Priorities' flagship research group, studies how the University senses a priority on approach and carries it through to a durable commitment — work that turns out to matter as much for a bay-expansion business case as for a five-year plan.

Recent work fitted the campus's EV-charging bollards with independent current clamps to test whether a rising "utilisation" figure reflected real demand or simply drivers reserving a bay. The distinction matters well beyond parking: it's the same distinction the Group applies whenever an institution has to decide how much of tomorrow's capacity to build on today's count. Partner support lets the Group keep applying that discipline early, before a plan hardens into a budget line no one can walk back.



Wellbeing, Counted

The voucher scheme at the centre of this campaign was never going to be simple. A benefit redeemed at a café till, a gym scanner, and a bookshop counter has to be tracked across three separate systems without losing the thread — and, as the University’s own dining-hall work has shown, a scheme’s enrolment figure and its redemption figure can tell two very different stories about who a benefit actually reaches.

That gap sits at the heart of the University’s Indicator Commons, the shared library its schools draw on when they build a tracking system meant to serve the people it’s watching rather than just the report about them. The wellbeing voucher scheme was built to close it from day one — counted at issue, counted again at the counter, and never allowed to drift the way a renewal figure can.

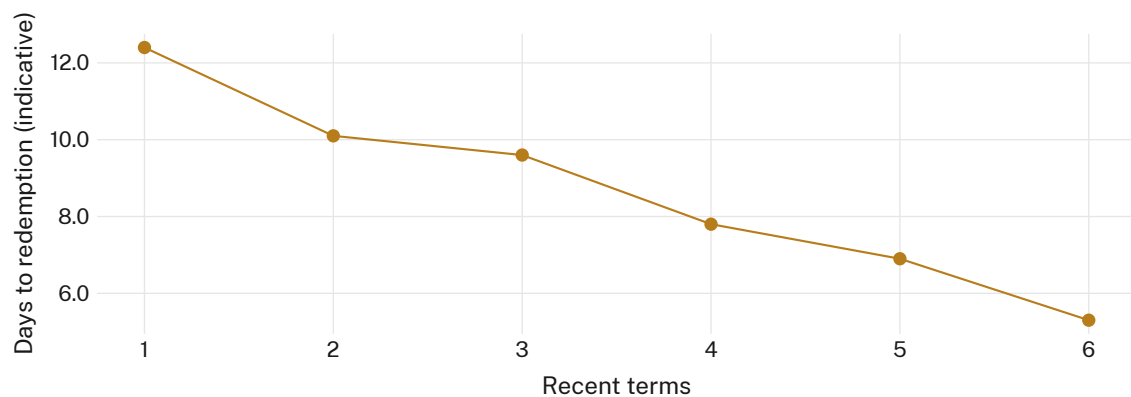
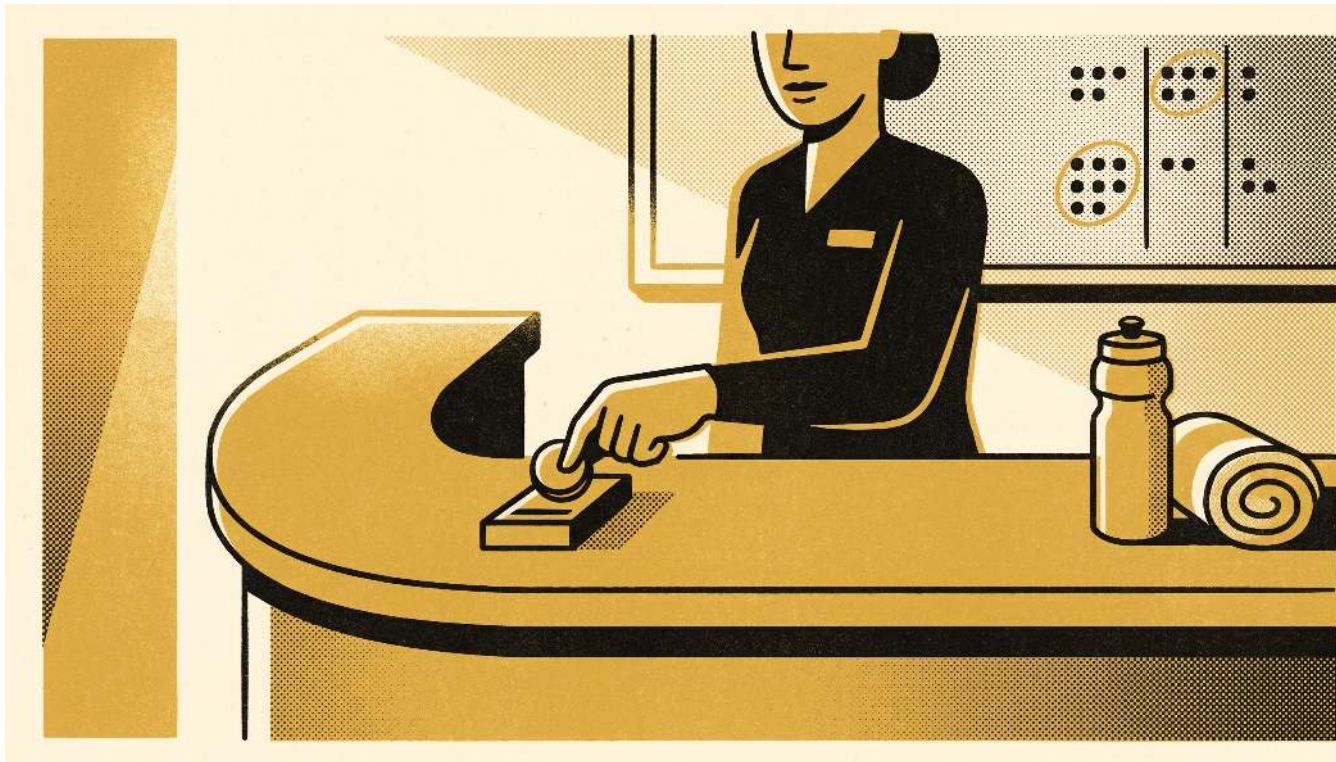


Figure 5: Indicative time from a wellbeing voucher being issued to being logged as redeemed, across recent terms. Measured internally; not a service commitment.

Support that's easy to find is support people actually use — which makes it worth knowing, gently, whether they do.

— Dr Mirela Hanke, Postdoctoral Fellow, School of Continuous Improvement

From our researchers

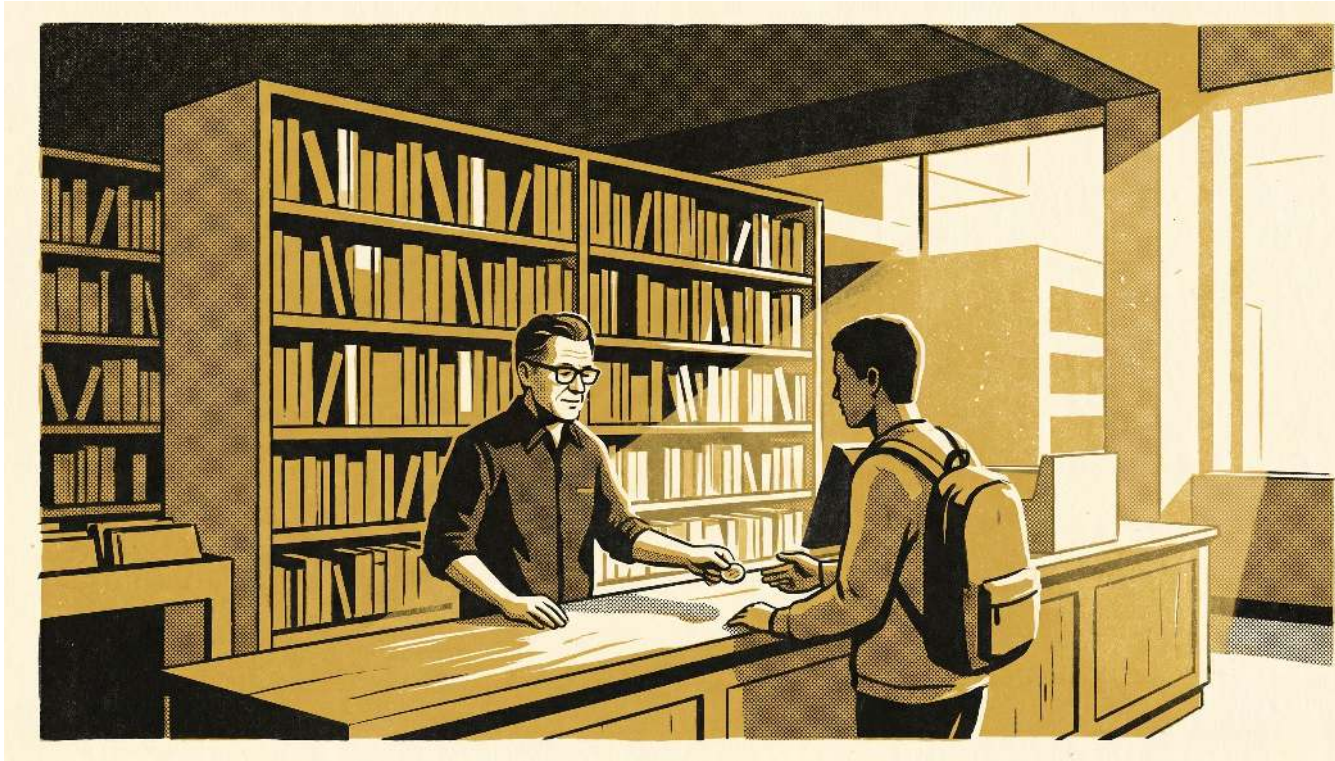
Partner support builds on published work already keeping the University honest about what its own systems do:

- **Renewed, Not Redeemed: A Two-Hall Comparison of an Opt-Out Meal-Plan Default Against Actual Redemption** — Joost Nwosu and Mirela Hanke test what an enrolment figure hides once it's checked against what's actually collected at the counter. doi:10.5555/slop.8ww6eg
- **Plugged, Not Pulling: A Failed Replication of the Water-Refill Tap/Fill Confound** — Fenna Okoro and Ingrid Vasseur ask what a parking bay “in use” really means once the meter is checked, informing how the University plans for tomorrow's demand today. doi:10.5555/slop.8rf611
- **Built Not to Watch: How CheckPoint's Participation Logs Reached the Living Dashboard Anyway** — Casimir Beng and Osei Vandermeer audit a wellbeing check-in tool built to stay separate from performance reporting, and what it took to keep that promise. doi:10.5555/slop.hxwf45

The people behind the work

Associate Professor Casimir Beng leads the Adaptive Metrics Lab, where measurement systems are built to be checked as rigorously as anything they measure.

Dr Fenna Okoro convenes the Horizon Register within the School of Emergent Priorities, tracking how a rolling account of priorities on approach ages once it meets the calendar.



Be part of it

None of this happens on goodwill alone. Behind every counter where a voucher changes hands sits a system someone has to build, check, and rebuild when the checking finds something wanting — and that work grows with the University's ambitions for it, not on its own.

Partners who support the Adaptive Metrics Lab, the Trajectory Analytics Group, or the wellbeing program directly help the University keep a promise that's easy to make and hard to keep: that support offered is support that reaches someone, and that the University will always know the difference.

A gift scoped to a single semester is enough to fund one full audit cycle — the kind of check that turns a promising redemption figure on paper into a number the University can actually stand behind at the counter. A gift scoped to a full year extends that cycle across every counter the voucher scheme touches, café to gym to bookshop alike, so no single term's figure has to carry the whole claim on its own.

Smaller gifts have a home too, in the Adaptive Metrics Lab's general fund for instrument upkeep — the unglamorous recalibrations that don't wait for a dedicated campaign but keep every other number on this page worth reading.

Join us. Every tier of support is acknowledged in the same register the University uses for its own findings, plainly and with the hedge left in. Details on partnering with

Slop University, and the full published record behind this brochure, are available at slop.university.



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